WTI RESEARCH / THE ONE-PAGE VIEW

Can we predict oil prices when markets are disrupted?

A 2020 idea, rebuilt and tested against oil-market history through early November 2026.

01 A rebound is not guaranteed.

The original equations do not prove that prices return to a stable level. A plausible market story still needs evidence.

No guaranteed return path

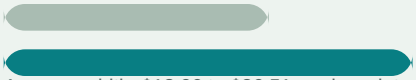
02 More complexity did not win consistently.

Across 19 original model settings and four horizons, only 2 of 76 matched comparisons beat the simple no-change forecast; both were at the shortest horizon.

Each dot = one matched comparison; teal = lower average error

03 Better short-term ranges have a cost.

At five WTI observations ahead, 2026 coverage rose from 58.5% to 90.2%, while the average range roughly doubled. Longer horizons remain unresolved.



Earlier: 58.5%

Pre-2026 selected rule: 90.2%

Average width: $13.06 to $26.51 per barrel; target coverage: 90%.

WHAT THIS CANNOT TELL US

Historical tests use revised data, not a new live trial. Wider ranges are not automatically better. Shipping and household effects are assumed illustrations, not measured tank levels or pump-price forecasts.